PRAWN AND SMOKED SALMON RAVIOLI

SERVES	TOTAL TIME
2	**1 h 30 min**

INGREDIENTS

200 g	Pasta — 00 flour
2	Pasta — eggs
1/2 tbsp	Pasta — olive oil
100 g	Filling — smoked salmon
50 ml	Filling — double cream
180 g	Filling — cooked prawns
1 tsp	Filling — dill, chopped
to taste	Filling — salt and black pepper
for dusting	Filling — semolina
to taste	To Serve — butter
1 tbsp	To Serve — dill, chopped
1	To Serve — lemon (juice)

METHOD

1. Make pasta dough: In a food processor combine the flour, eggs and olive oil and blend until a coarse crumb has been formed. Pour out onto the work surface and work it into a dough. Leave to rest for at least 30 minutes at room temperature.
2. Prepare filling: Add half of the smoked salmon and cream to a blender and blend to form a paste. Roughly chop the remaining smoked salmon and add to a bowl with the prawns and dill. Season with salt and pepper, mix well and chill in the fridge for 20 minutes.
3. Roll pasta: Divide the pasta dough into workable pieces. Using a pasta machine, roll out the pasta, beginning with the widest setting and finishing with the second narrowest. When not using dough, make sure that it remains covered to avoid drying out.
4. Form ravioli: Spoon about ½ teaspoon of filling at intervals along the length of the pasta. Brush a little water around each filling and lay a second rolled piece of pasta on top. Seal the pasta tightly around the filling and using a stencil cut through the pasta. Make sure your stencil is lightly floured to prevent it from sticking.
5. Cook: Add each ravioli to a baking tray which has been lightly coated with semolina. Bring a large pot of salted water to the boil. Cook the ravioli for 4-5 minutes.
6. Serve: Gently toss in melted butter, a squeeze of lemon juice, a sprinkle of dill and season with salt and pepper.

NOTES

Georgina shares her ideas for a romantic meal and how to make the classic Italian dish of ravioli which she stuffs with prawn and smoked salmon. The extra effort put into a home-made delicious dinner is worth more than any over-priced flowers and elaborate gifts - the way to the heart is through the stomach!
Chef's Tips: Never overfill the ravioli - however nice the filling is! It isn't worth it when they burst when cooking. Another way to prevent the ravioli 'erupting' in the water is to make sure when sealing that there is no air bubbles between the pasta and filling.

FILLING

Prawn and Smoked Salmon Filling

INGREDIENTS

100 g	Smoked salmon
50 ml	Double cream
180 g	Cooked prawns
1 tsp	Dill, chopped
to taste	Salt and black pepper

METHOD

1. Blend half the smoked salmon with the cream to a paste.
2. Roughly chop the other half of the salmon.
3. Put the chopped salmon in a bowl with the prawns and dill, add the paste, season and mix well.

4. Chill 20 minutes.

NOTES

No sub-components, but the salmon splits in two: half becomes a cream paste that binds, half stays in rough pieces for texture. Do not blend all of it.
The prawns go in already cooked, so the filling only needs the 4-5 minutes the pasta takes.
About 1/2 teaspoon per raviolo. The source's warning is against overfilling, however good the mix tastes, because they burst.
Water, not egg, is brushed round each mound to seal.
The 1 tbsp dill and the lemon in the source's serving list dress the cooked ravioli and are not part of the filling.

SHAPE

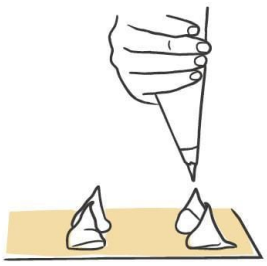
Ravioli

Region: All of Italy, north to south, and worldwide / Rest: 45 minutes to 1 hour uncovered in the refrigerator

METHOD

1. Make your chosen egg-based dough, then roll and sheet it.
2. Dust a wooden board with 00 flour. Cover a sheet pan with parchment, then dust the parchment with semolina.
3. Trim the sheets to 18-inch lengths with a knife and cut away the ragged edges. Save the scraps for soup. Keep the sheets under plastic wrap or a towel.
4. Lay one sheet on the board. Using a pastry bag cut to a 1-inch opening, pipe mounds of filling roughly 1 1/2 inches across and 1/2 inch high in an even run down the sheet, leaving about 2 inches between mounds.
5. If the dough feels dry rather than moderately tacky, mist it with a spray bottle held 8 to 10 inches above the board so the second sheet will stick. Skip this if the dough is already tacky.
6. Lay a second sheet gently over the first, edges lined up and no wrinkles.
7. Press around each mound with your two index fingers to expel the air pockets. For insurance, flip a #30 (1 1/8-inch) plain round cutter to its dull side and press gently over each mound to expel the last of the air.
8. For square ravioli, cut 2 1/2-inch squares with a fluted pastry cutter or fluted dough divider. A 2 1/2-inch fluted square cutter does the same thing.
9. For round ravioli, use a #60 (2 3/8-inch) plain round cutter. Press straight down with your palm flat on top of the cutter, then twist it clockwise under that pressure to finish the cut.
10. Lift the sheets from one end to peel away the surrounding scrap. Discard it or save it for soup.
11. Set the pieces on the prepared pan in a single layer and dust the pan again with semolina.
12. Repeat with the remaining sheets.
13. Refrigerate uncovered for 45 minutes to 1 hour to dry. Covered pieces sweat and get too wet. To hold longer, lay plastic wrap loosely over the pan and refrigerate up to 8 hours.

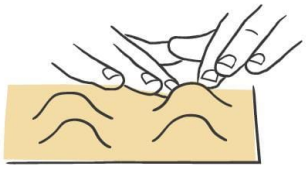
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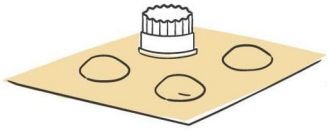
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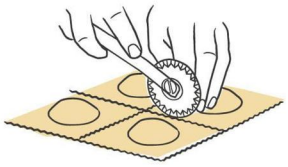
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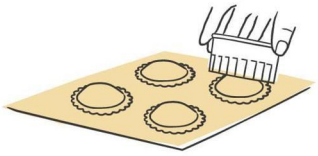
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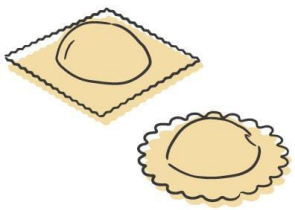
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NOTES

Two-sheet construction from 18-inch sheets. The filling goes on the bottom sheet and a second sheet covers it.
Filling per piece: a mound 1 1/2 inches across and 1/2 inch high, piped through a 1-inch opening.
Spacing: mounds 2 inches apart. The cut is either a 2 1/2-inch square or a 2 3/8-inch round.
Cutters: #30 (1 1/8-inch) plain round cutter used dull side down to expel air, then either a fluted cutter or divider for 2 1/2-inch squares, or a #60 (2 3/8-inch) plain round cutter for rounds.
Cutting technique for rounds: press with a flat palm, then rotate clockwise under pressure so the cut goes all the way through.
Air is expelled twice before cutting, first with two index fingers and then with the dull cutter.
The author's restaurant version is round, roughly 2 inches across, with a ruffled edge. The square version is the red-sauce shape.
Storage: 45 minutes to 1 hour uncovered to dry, then up to 8 hours refrigerated under loose plastic.
Red sauce is the default finish. Otherwise the shape is a test bed for any filling.

DOUGH

Egg Dough

Makes: 954 g / Active Time: 8-10 min kneading / Rest: 30 min minimum, wrapped

INGREDIENTS

500 g	Tipo 00 flour
454 g	Egg yolks
as needed	Extra 00 flour for kneading
up to 1 tbsp, only if dry	Room-temperature water

METHOD

1. Mix the yolks lightly, without beating them.
2. Mound the flour on a wooden surface and open a well 5 to 6 inches across. Wider than that and the walls collapse.
3. Add half the yolks, drawing in flour from the inner wall with a fork, working round the circumference.
4. Add the rest the same way. If the wall breaks, scrape the escape back into the flour until the mass holds itself.
5. Knead 8 to 10 minutes: press down and away with the heel of your hand, rotate 180 degrees, fold, repeat. Scrape your hands and the board as you go.
6. Add water a tablespoon at a time only if it stays dry and refuses to come together.
7. Stop when it is smooth, firm, and springs back slightly when poked. The texture to aim for is Play-Doh.
8. Wrap and rest at least 30 minutes before rolling.

NOTES

454 g of yolks is roughly 24 to 26 eggs, so plan what the whites are for.
Yolks only, no whites and no whole eggs, which is what makes this rich and tender rather than elastic.
Dry winter air is the usual reason it will not come together. Flour the board sparingly, since excess dries it out.
Keeps 24 hours. Chilled overnight, pull it out 20 minutes before rolling.

DATE ____ / ____ / ____ RATING ____ / 5 OVEN ADJ _____

NOTES _____

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